

The power of positive thinking

It is only natural to feel emotionally and energetically **drained** when surrounded by negativity. **People** who constantly complain or **criticise** **can deplete** our inner energy and lower our “prana” — the life force that **sustains** us. **In contrast**, **individuals** with a positive **disposition** **uplift** us. They **radiate warmth** and **optimism**, qualities that make them naturally likeable and often deeply inspiring.

True success in life is not **merely** measured by financial wealth. One may be a millionaire or an industry leader, but what truly **matters** is the **legacy** one leaves behind — a legacy that inspires future generations to innovate, create, and live with purpose. Take, **for instance**, Steve Jobs — co-founder of Apple and one of the most iconic innovators of our time. His life story is not just about creating revolutionary technology, but about a mindset — one **rooted in** curiosity, creativity, and **resilience**.

Despite his **eccentric** habits, including experimenting with LSD and **following** a strict **fruitarian** diet, Jobs maintained a sharp, forward-thinking mind that **propelled** Apple to unimaginable heights. His vision continues to influence the tech world long after his passing. Jobs wasn't perfect, but he **embodied** the power of positive action. Apple has continued to evolve, recently releasing the iPhone 16 — a **testament** to the **enduring spark Jobs ignited**. He proved that positively **inclined** individuals are capable of achieving the extraordinary. To them, the word “impossible” doesn't exist. As His **Holiness** the Dalai Lama once said, “**In order to** carry a positive action, we must develop here a positive vision.” **A person** with such a vision **is** generous, **productive**, and **constructive**. They are not ego-driven or self-absorbed, but instead see their challenges as small compared to the larger **suffering** in the world.

Even when Steve Jobs faced a **terminal** illness like pancreatic cancer, his passion didn't **waver**. He continued to innovate, inspire, and **strive for** excellence. **His life**, though **marked** by physical **deterioration**, **was** also filled with **immense** creativity and **unwavering drive**. Khalil Gibran **aptly** described the selfish and self-absorbed, saying, “Wisdom **ceases** to be wisdom when it becomes too proud to **weep**, too grave to laugh, and too selfish to seek other than itself.” Negativity, selfishness, and jealousy are **detrimental to** personal growth. We **encounter** such individuals in our lives — be it in families, workplaces, or social circles. They are quick to ask for help, but rarely offer it. **In the long run**, they lose the trust and respect of others. Positively inclined people, on the other hand, view money as a **means**, not an end. They live for a larger **cause** — one that includes serving society and uplifting others. This gives them inner peace and a sense of fulfilment that money alone cannot buy. Negativity, in contrast, **leads** only **to** dissatisfaction, **strained** relationships, and a hollow sense of existence. Creative and enthusiastic individuals are often deeply **immersed in** their passions — whether it's technology, music, science, or art. This devotion becomes a form of meditation, bringing joy and meaning to their lives. Jobs led a remarkably simple life despite his wealth. Similarly, Dr APJ Abdul Kalam, India's **beloved** “Missile Man,” owned little material wealth, yet his vision and **humility** inspired an entire generation. Both men were spiritual in their own ways — Jobs drew from Zen philosophy and Indian meditation, while Kalam found **solace** in music and literature. Their lives

remind us that success is as much about the spirit as it is about science. Truly productive individuals don't wear masks. They are authentic — what you see is what you get. **Sports legends** like Kapil Dev and Virender Sehwag, for instance, **were** aggressive on the field but warm and genuine off it. They didn't waste energy on gossip or criticism but **channelled** their focus into their **craft**. Another **hallmark** of such individuals **is** their refusal to **wallow in self-pity**. They don't let others' opinions define them.

Instead, they stay focused, take responsibility, and act with purpose. They step outside their comfort zones to help others, finding deep satisfaction in doing so. As Steve Jobs once said, "Being the richest man in the **cemetery** doesn't matter to me. Going to bed at night and saying we've done something wonderful — that's what matters to me." That sentiment captures the essence of a life well-lived — one that goes beyond wealth to create meaning, impact, and inspiration. **[Practice Exercise]**

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.
- **Means** (noun) – a method of doing something साधन
- **Cause** (noun) – Objective, purpose वजह
- **Craft** (noun) – Skill, dexterity, expertise, ability, निपुणता

Vocabulary

1. **Drained** (adjective) – exhausted, fatigued, depleted, worn-out, tired थका हुआ
2. **Criticise** (verb) – blame, censure, condemn, denounce, fault आलोचना करना
3. **Deplete** (verb) – exhaust, drain, consume, diminish, reduce घटाना / समाप्त करना
4. **Sustain** (verb) – maintain, support, nourish, uphold, preserve बनाए रखना
5. **In contrast** (phrase) – conversely, on the other hand, however, nevertheless, whereas इसके विपरीत
6. **Disposition** (noun) – temperament, nature, attitude, character, mindset स्वभाव / प्रवृत्ति
7. **Uplift** (verb) – elevate, inspire, boost, raise, enhance प्रोत्साहित करना / उठाना
8. **Radiate** (verb) – emit, shine, glow, emanate, exude फैलाना / उजागर करना
9. **Warmth** (noun) – kindness, affection, tenderness, comfort, friendliness स्नेह / गर्मजोशी
10. **Optimism** (noun) – hopefulness, positivity, confidence, assurance, enthusiasm आशावाद
11. **Merely** (adverb) – only, simply, just, barely, solely केवल
12. **Matter** (verb) – count, be important, make a difference, weigh, affect महत्त्व रखना
13. **Legacy** (noun) – inheritance, heritage, contribution, gift, endowment विरासत
14. **For instance** (phrase) – for example, such as, to illustrate, like, say उदाहरण के लिए
15. **Root** (in) (verb) – base, ground, found, anchor, establish आधारित होना
16. **Resilience** (noun) – toughness, strength, flexibility, durability, perseverance दृढ़ता
17. **Eccentric** (adjective) – odd, unconventional, unusual, quirky, peculiar सनकी
18. **Following** (preposition) – after, subsequent to, in the wake of, later than, as a result of के बाद
19. **Fruitarian** (adjective) – fruit-based, fruit-consuming, raw-food, plant-eating, vegan-like केवल फलाहार लेने वाला
20. **Propel** (verb) – drive, push, thrust, motivate, launch प्रेरित करना
21. **Embody** (verb) – represent, personify, exemplify, manifest, express मूर्त रूप देना / प्रतिबिंबित करना
22. **Testament** (to) (noun) – evidence, proof, witness, indication, demonstration प्रमाण / साक्ष्य

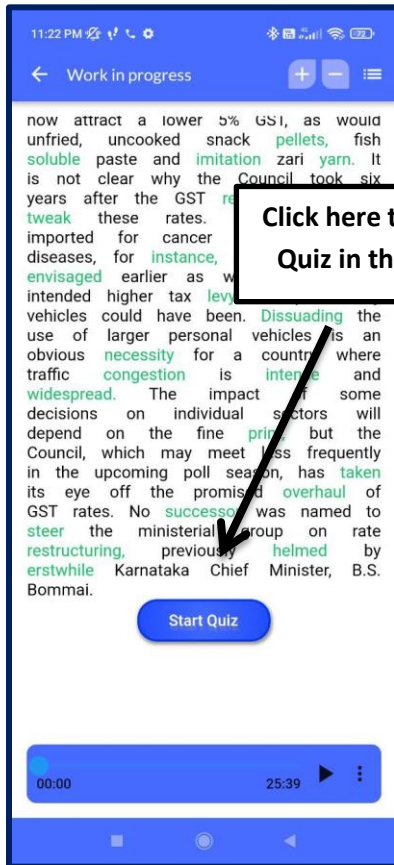
23. **Enduring** (adjective) – lasting, persistent, eternal, timeless, long-standing दीर्घकालिक
24. **Spark** (noun) – trigger, inspiration, flash, start, impulse प्रेरणा
25. **Ignite** (verb) – light, kindle, trigger, spark, stimulate प्रज्वलित करना
26. **Inclined** (adjective) – prone, disposed, tending, apt, leaning प्रवृत्त / इच्छुक
27. **Holiness** (noun) – sacredness, divinity, sanctity, piety, spirituality पवित्रता
28. **In order to** (phrase) – so as to, with the intention of, to, for the purpose of ताकि / के लिए
29. **Productive** (adjective) – efficient, fruitful, effective, industrious, constructive उत्पादक
30. **Constructive** (adjective) – positive, helpful, useful, beneficial, purposeful रचनात्मक
31. **Suffering** (noun) – pain, distress, misery, agony, hardship पीड़ा / दुख
32. **Terminal** (adjective) – (used about an illness) slowly causing death लाइलाज
33. **Waver** (verb) – hesitate, fluctuate, falter, vacillate, sway डगमगाना
34. **Strive** (for) (verb) – attempt, struggle, endeavour, aim, work hard प्रयास करना
35. **Mark** (verb) – indicate, denote, show, signify, highlight चिन्हित करना
36. **Deterioration** (noun) – decline, weakening, decay, degeneration, worsening गिरावट
37. **Immense** (adjective) – huge, vast, enormous, tremendous, massive विशाल
38. **Unwavering** (adjective) – steady, firm, resolute, consistent, determined अडिग
39. **Drive** (noun) – motivation, ambition, initiative, push, determination प्रेरणा
40. **Aptly** (adverb) – suitably, fittingly, appropriately, precisely, accurately उपयुक्त रूप से
41. **Cease** (verb) – stop, end, discontinue, halt, terminate रोकना
42. **Weep** (verb) – cry, sob, shed tears, lament, mourn रोना
43. **Detrimental** (to) (adjective) – harmful, damaging, injurious, destructive, adverse हानिकारक
44. **Encounter** (verb) – meet, face, come across, confront, experience सामना करना
45. **In the long run** (phrase) – eventually, over time, ultimately, in the end, in the future दीर्घकाल में
46. **Lead** (to) (verb) – result in, cause, bring about, contribute to, generate वजह बनना

47. **Strained** (adjective) – tense, stressed, uneasy, troubled, difficult तनावपूर्ण
48. **Immerse** (in) (verb) – involve, engage, absorb, submerge, engross डूब जाना / शामिल होना
49. **Beloved** (adjective) – loved, cherished, dear, adored, treasured प्रिय
50. **Humility** (noun) – modesty, meekness, humbleness, lack of pride, submission विनम्रता
51. **Solace** (noun) – comfort, consolation, relief, support, reassurance सांत्वना / दिलासा
52. **Channel** (verb) – direct, guide, focus, divert, convey मार्गदर्शन करना
53. **Hallmark** (noun) – trait, characteristic, sign, feature, indicator विशेषता
54. **Wallow in** (phrasal verb) – indulge in, revel in, sink into, dwell on, be absorbed in डूब जाना (नकारात्मक भावना में)
55. **Self-pity** (noun) – misery, self-sorrow, self-sympathy, feeling sorry for oneself, hopelessness आत्मदया
56. **Cemetery** (noun) – graveyard, burial ground, necropolis, churchyard, memorial park कब्रिस्तान

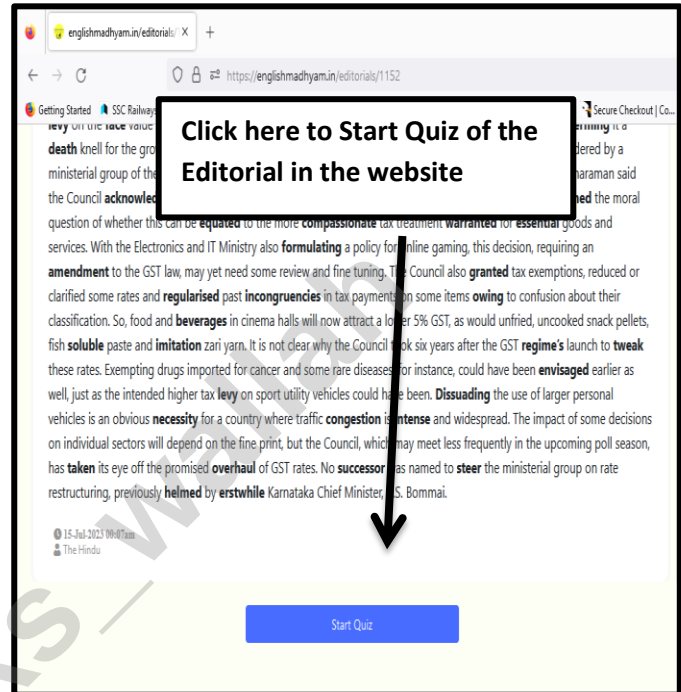
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Negativity drains energy** – Constant criticism and complaints from others can deplete our emotional and energetic reserves, reducing our *prana* or life force.
2. **Positivity uplifts** – People with optimistic and warm demeanours can inspire and energize those around them, becoming natural sources of motivation.
3. **True success is beyond wealth** – Life should not be judged solely by material gain, but by the **legacy** and **positive impact** one leaves behind.
4. **Steve Jobs as a symbol of visionary thinking** – Despite his unconventional habits, Jobs' creativity and curiosity led to groundbreaking innovations that continue to shape the tech industry.
5. **Positive action has lasting influence** – Jobs' mindset and mission continue through Apple's evolution, including the launch of the **iPhone 16**, long after his death.
6. **Positive vision leads to positive outcomes** – As the Dalai Lama emphasized, **vision** precedes action. A positive outlook results in productivity, generosity, and constructive efforts.
7. **Overcoming adversity with purpose** – Even while battling terminal illness, Jobs pursued innovation with undiminished passion and commitment.
8. **Selfishness blocks wisdom** – As Khalil Gibran warned, egotism and jealousy hinder growth and wisdom, while humility and openness allow for deeper personal evolution.
9. **Negative individuals lose trust** – Those who are self-centered and unhelpful may benefit temporarily but ultimately lose respect and connection with others.
10. **Positively driven individuals live with purpose** – They view **money as a tool** and prioritize service, community, and **inner fulfillment**.
11. **Passion becomes meditation** – Creatively inclined people immerse themselves in art, technology, or science, drawing deep joy and meaning from their pursuits.
12. **Simplicity and spirituality in leadership** – Both **Steve Jobs** and **APJ Abdul Kalam** lived simple lives, drawing strength from spirituality, reflection, and literature.
13. **Authenticity matters** – Truly impactful people are **genuine and consistent**, not performative; their inner and outer selves align.
14. **Focus over frivolity** – Like Sehwaag and Kapil Dev, high achievers avoid gossip and criticism, channeling energy into refining their skills.
15. **Purpose defines greatness** – As Jobs said, it's not about being the richest, but about **doing something wonderful** and **meaningful**, which defines a life well-lived.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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